Run[redacted]a realistic Chef Load [redacted]nst Chef 360 DSM[redacted]

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> **Artic[redacted]e:** A practical guide for operat[redacted]ant t[redacted]ad `chef-load`, generate realis[redacted]nfra Client or InSpec traffic[redacted]pare th[redacted]with an on-premises Chef 360 Depl[redacted]ervice Manager (DSM) d[redacted]

[redacted]nd scope[redacted]

- Ex[redacted]at the sample loa[redacted]
- D[redacted]target audienc[redacted]
  de[redacted]
- Li[redacted]Che[redacted]

now how to download and verify the archive ary.
now how to install or unpack it without overw an existing test installation.
erify the installation with the version/help con d.
xplain where the sample configuration and de TOML file are located.

4. nfigure the sample load

4.1 ect the client or InSpec version

now the version-selection option or TOML se
rovide a short example for each supported ch
- `chef-client` 18
- `chef-client` 19
- `inspec` 5
- `inspec` 6
- `inspec` 7

xplain that the selected version should reflect ata shape and event behavior of the operator's urrent estate.

4.2 nfigure the Automate data collector end t

now where to set the DSM Automate data col endpoint.
now how to provide credentials and TLS setti ecurely.
xplain how to confirm that the endpoint is the ded DSM service before starting a sustained st.
all out any required proxy, certificate-authorit eout, retry, or concurrency settings.

4.3 ault TOML file parameters

Do nt the default TOML file in a reference table. very parameter, include its exact key, type, de valid range or values, and operational effect.

P eter group	Parameters to document	Why it matters
E nt and a tication	Automate data collector URL, credentials, TLS/CA settings	Determines the DSM target and
W ad selection	Chef Infra Client/InSpec product a version	
T uration	Start time, duration, steady-state period, ramp-up, ramp-down	
L ate	Nodes, runs, scans, events per second, or equivalent rate contro	
C rrency	Workers, batches, queues, and connection limits	
Realistic data	Node data, runlists, cookbooks, profiles, inputs, and fixtures	

P group	Parameters to document	Why it matters
Relat	Timeout, retry, backoff, and failure	Separates transient failures from capacity limits

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Scen	Product/version	Data set	Offered load	Goal
Expec lo	Current fleet	Production-shaped sample	peak	recommendation
Peak	Current version	Production-shaped sample	Peak plus headroom	Find saturation behavior
Versio comp	18/19 or InSpec 5/6/7	Same data where compatible	Same rate	Identify version-related differences

6. Ru e sample load

- t low-rate smoke test.
- S he command that uses the TOML file and selected version.
- S ow to ramp gradually to the expected and peak rates.
- Record the exact configuration, fixture revision, cluster shape, DSM image version, and test time
-

Use the load results and pod counters to validate the recommendation under the expected and peak workload.
Leave operational headroom; do not size to the first visible saturation point.

- I e a sample results table and a short interpretation example.
- E n why throughput alone is insufficient when latency or errors rise.

9. W o do when DSM pods are saturated

9.1 Co the saturation signal

- V that pod CPU or memory, queue depth, latency, or error rate is the limiting factor.
- C whether pods are already distributed across available nodes.
- F ut a constrained node, storage, network, or downstream dependency.

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- Client-
- Pods re
- How to
- Data-h

11. Reproc

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- [ ] Expected and peak load rates recorded.
- [ ] Latency, error, saturation, and scaling results retained.
- [ ] Follow-up sizing or deployment changes documented.

12. Reference material

- Chef 360 DSM documentation
- `chef-load` installation and command reference.
- The generated/default TOML configuration reference.
- Kubernetes and DSM monitoring dashboards used during the test.